DESIGN

TREND

SUNKEN TREASURE

Designers are reinterpreting the classic conversation pit for modern lifestyles—more flexible and versatile, the new editions wield far more flex than their predecessors.

Pallavi Mehra



Sunken living spaces or 'conversation pits' were a popular feature in mid-century homes. The trend slowly disappeared, in part due to the pits' safety concerns. However, in recent years, there's been a rise in the popularity of these structures. However, the new, reimagined pits feature sleek lines, sophisticated materials, and smart technology, which help them become an elegant extension of modern homes.

Leading interior designers and architects explain how these spaces are evolving from their 20th-century roots into refined, functional, and aesthetically resonant features of contemporary living. "The old-school sunken seating has evolved into clean, low-profile designs with modular furniture, soft layering through textures,